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Strategic Trading Analysis

Based on the detailed PDF report provided (dated February 2026), here is the analysis from the perspective of a positional equity trader.

Step 1: Audit the Data

- **Data Present:**
  - **Price Structure:** Daily charts (3-Year), Weekly trends, Intraday (15-min) trends.
  - **Trend Indicators:** Moving Averages (EMA 20, 50, 200), Supertrend, MACD.
  - **Volatility:** Bollinger Bands, Band Width, Volatility Squeeze analysis.
  - **Momentum/Strength:** RSI, Relative Strength (RS) against Benchmark (^NSEBANK).
  - **Volume:** Volume Analysis with specific signal flags (Exhaustion/Churn).
  - **Fundamentals:** Basic growth metrics (Revenue, EPS, ROE) and Analyst Forecasts.
- **Data Missing:**
  - **Detailed Sector Breadth:** While RS against the Bank index is provided, broader market breadth (Nifty 50 context) is not detailed.
  - **Option Chain Data:** No Open Interest (OI) data provided, which would help identify resistance at strike prices (e.g., 130 or 135 levels).
- **Confidence Level: High.** The report provides a comprehensive technical view with conflicting signals (bullish trend vs. volume exhaustion) clearly marked, allowing for a nuanced decision. Note: The report dates are in the future (2026); analysis treats this data as "current" relative to the report's timeline.

Step 2: Analyze the Setup

- **Trend & Structure:** The stock is in a **Strong Uptrend**. It is trading above all key EMAs (20, 50, 200). The EMAs are stacked bullishly. The "Golden Cross" is well established.
- **Momentum Confluence:**
  - **MACD: Bullish** crossover with strengthening momentum.
  - **Supertrend:** Triggered a fresh "BUY" signal on 2026-02-20 at 118.02.
  - **Volatility Squeeze:** A "**Bullish** Breakout" was triggered on 2026-02-18. This is a high-probability setup for a multi-week move.
- **Relative Strength:** PNB.NS is an "Outperforming Leader" on 1M, 3M, 6M, and 1Y timeframes compared to the Bank index, although the RS score is a moderate 52.8.
- **Risk Factors:**
  - **Overextension:** The price (129.59) is currently above the Upper Bollinger Band (128.81). This suggests the stock is statistically expensive in the very short term ("walking the bands").
  - **Volume Warning:** A "Buying Exhaustion (**Bearish** Div)" signal was detected on 2026-02-20. This often precedes a short-term consolidation or pullback.

Step 3: Formulate the Recommendation

Verdict: YES (With strict risk management).

Despite the "Buying Exhaustion" warning, the confluence of a **Volatility Squeeze Breakout**, **Supertrend Flip**, and **EMA alignment** favors the bulls. In strong trending moves, stocks can remain "overbought" (above Bollinger Bands) for extended periods. We will treat this as a momentum breakout trade.

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- **Entry Price: INR 129.00 - INR 130.00** (Current Market Price).

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- *Note:* If the stock opens below 128, wait for a reclaim of 129 before entering to avoid catching a falling knife during a pullback.

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- **Stop Loss: INR 122.50** (Daily Closing Basis).

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- *Rationale:* This level places the stop just below the confluence of the EMA 50 (123.24) and the EMA 20 (124.32). If the price closes below the EMA 50, the momentum thesis is invalidated.

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- **Take Profit: INR 142.00 - INR 145.00** (Target Horizon: 4-8 Weeks).

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- *Rationale:* This targets a ~10-12% move, projecting a breakout above the recent structural resistance seen on the chart (approx 135). Breaking 135 should lead to a measured move toward 145.

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Candlestick Classification Analysis

Based on the **Candlestick Classification System** provided in the report, here is my analysis as a seasoned Price Action Trader.

Executive Summary: Bullish Bias with Momentum Building

The immediate price direction leans to the **Upside (Bullish)**. The market has shifted from a state of indecision/correction into a structured recovery, evidenced by the transition to "Buyer Control" and a positive 10-day trend score.

Detailed Technical Analysis

1. Current Classification: Buyer Control (+1)

- **The Signal:** The latest daily candle is classified as **Buyer Control**.
- **Decoding the Algorithm:**
  - **Body Strength (Step 1):** The candle likely had a moderate bullish body (0.8-1.5 ATR). This shows buyers are willing to hold price higher than the open, but it wasn't an explosive expansion.
  - **Close Position (Step 2):** The price closed in the upper portion of the daily range. This is crucial-it indicates that intraday sellers were absorbed, and buyers were comfortable holding positions overnight.
  - **Volume (Step 4):** Since it is "Buyer Control" and not "Strong Buyer Control," the volume was likely average or slightly below the 1.3x threshold. This suggests a steady grind higher rather than a frenzied institutional accumulation *on this specific day*.

2. Trend Score Analysis (10-Day Avg: 0.30)

- **Interpretation:** The 10-day average score is positive (+0.30).
- **Context:** In a system where 0 is "No Control," a positive score indicates that over the last two weeks, the net sum of price action has favored the bulls. The bears tried to push (evidenced by the red candles in the prior dip on Page 21), but they failed to sustain negative scores. The trend is shifting from "Correction" to "Accumulation."

3. Chart Visuals (Page 21 - Candlestick & Volume)

- **The "Anchor" Move:** Looking at the far right of the chart on Page 21, specifically late January/early February, there was a sharp dip (Red/Seller Control). However, notice the recovery. We see a large Green candle recently (likely a **Buyer Strong Control** or high-conviction **Buyer Control**).
- **Volume Validation:** The volume bars at the bottom of Page 21 show a significant spike corresponding with the beginning of this current upward leg. According to **Step 4** of your logic, this volume multiplied the bullish signal, confirming that "Smart Money" stepped in to defend the price support.
- **Current Structure:** Following that impulse move, the recent candles are Light Green (Buyer Control) and Grey (No Control). This is a classic "Impulse -> Consolidation -> Continuation" pattern. The buyers are in control, but they are catching their breath.

Prediction & Trade Setup

Direction: UP / LONG

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The Logic: The classification algorithm has identified a shift in character. The market spent a significant period in "No Control" (Grey candles dominant in the distribution stats: 118 count), representing a lack of conviction. The recent shift to **Buyer Control (+1)** combined with a positive trend score signals that conviction has returned to the buy side.

What to Expect:1. **Immediate Term:** Expect the price to challenge the recent swing highs (visible around the 135 level on the chart). The "Buyer Control" status suggests the price will grind upward toward this resistance.2. **Warning Sign:** If we see a candle classified as "No Control" (0) with a long upper wick (Step 3 of the algorithm), it would signal rejection at resistance.3. **Confirmation:** A breakout requires a **Buyer Strong Control (+2)** candle-specifically one with **High Volume (>1.3x avg)**-to clear the 135 supply zone.

Verdict: The bulls are driving. As long as the classification remains > 0 (Buyer Control or No Control with positive closes), the path of least resistance is higher.

News & Analyst Targets

As a stock research analyst, I have compiled the latest news, brokerage views, and market developments for **Punjab National Bank (PNB)** for the week ending February 21, 2026.

1) Latest News for PNB This Week (Feb 15 - Feb 21, 2026)

- **Significant Volume Surge & Price Action:** On Friday, February 20, PNB stock witnessed a massive surge in trading volume, rising approximately **3.2% to 3.4%** intraday. The stock closed near **INR 130**, outperforming the broader PSU Bank index. This indicates renewed buying interest from institutional or large retail investors.
- **Bad Loan Auction (Gammon India):** A key deadline occurred this week regarding PNB's effort to clean up its balance sheet. The bank had set **February 17, 2026**, as the date for receiving binding bids for the sale of its INR 514 crore exposure to **Gammon India**. This is part of a larger INR 760+ crore distressed asset sale that also includes Simbhaoli Sugars.
- **Lending Rates Unchanged:** Earlier this month, PNB announced it would keep its Repo Linked Lending Rate (RLLR) and Marginal Cost of Funds Based Lending Rate (MCLR) **unchanged** for February. This decision ensures stable interest income margins for the bank in the immediate term.

2) Brokerage Upgrades & Downgrades

The analyst community is currently **divided** on PNB, with domestic brokers generally more bullish than their foreign counterparts.

- **Downgrade: MarketsMojo** recently downgraded PNB from 'Buy' to **'Hold'**, citing technical factors and a need for caution despite the stock's long-term potential.
- **Maintained Ratings:**
  - **CLSA** has maintained an **'Outperform'** rating, keeping its target price steady at **INR 145**.
  - **Morgan Stanley** remains bearish with an **'Underweight'** rating and a target of **INR 100**, seeing better value elsewhere in the sector.
  - **Citi** has maintained a **'Sell'** rating but slightly raised its target to **INR 115**, acknowledging some price resilience.

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3) Indirect News Impacting PNB

- **RBI Policy "Pause" (Neutral Stance):** The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) kept the repo rate unchanged at **5.25%** in its February meeting. While there was chatter about a cumulative 125 bps cut over the FY25-26 cycle, the central bank has now hit a "pause" to monitor inflation. This stability is neutral-to-positive for PNB, allowing it to maintain its Net Interest Margins (NIMs) without immediate pressure to lower loan rates further.
- **Post-Budget Sentiment:** The banking sector is still digesting the Union Budget 2026 (presented Feb 1), which did **not** announce any fresh capital infusion for PSU banks. While initially taken negatively, the market has realized that large banks like PNB are now self-sufficient in capital, leading to the recovery seen in the stock price this week.

4) Latest Analyst Targets for PNB

Brokerage / Analyst Firm	Rating / Stance	Target Price (INR)	Comments
IDBI Capital	Buy	152	Bullish on asset quality improvement.
CLSA	Outperform	145	Sees further upside from current levels.
Motilal Oswal	Buy	145	Maintained positive outlook post-earnings.
Trendlyne Consensus	Hold/Accumulate	141.50	Average of multiple analyst estimates.
SMT (SEBI Reg.)	Buy	135	Short-term technical target.
Simply Wall St	N/A	132	Fair value estimate based on cash flows.
Citi	Sell	115	Cautious on valuation; raised from lower target.
Morgan Stanley	Underweight	100	Concerns over operational efficiency vs. peers.

Analyst Summary: The stock is currently trading around **INR 130**. The consensus suggests limited downside risk, with a potential upside of **~10-15%** if the bullish targets (INR 145+) are met. However, divergence between foreign (bearish) and domestic (bullish) views suggests volatility may continue.

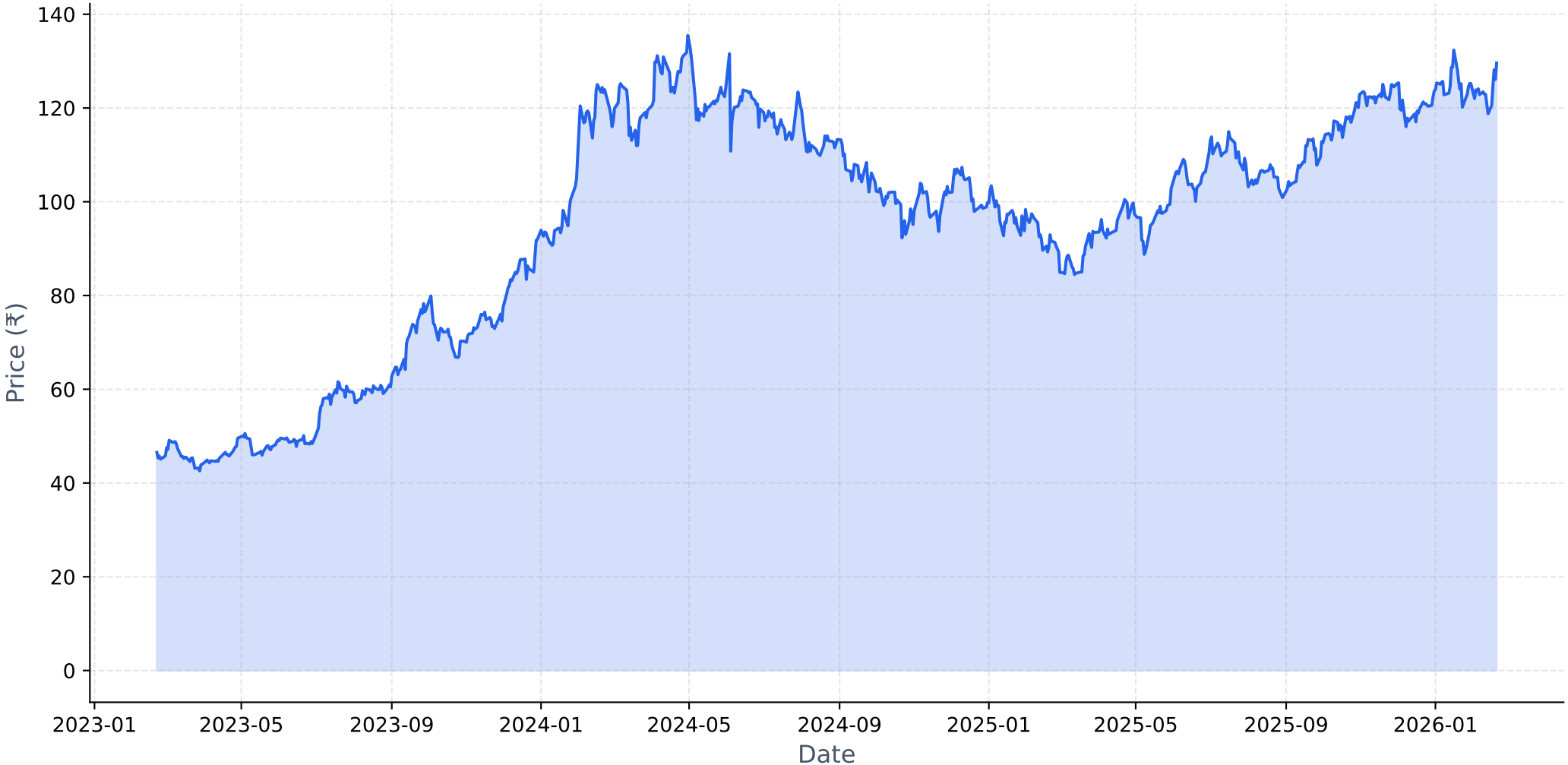
Stock Detailed Analysis Report

PNB.NS

Current Price: ₹129.59

Generated: 2026-02-21 09:18

PNB.NS - 3 Year Daily Price Chart



Long-term Fundamental Analysis (4 Years)

Metric	Is Growing?	Accelerating?	1Y Growth	3Y CAGR
Revenue	Yes	No	8.14%	13.24%
Net Income	Yes	Yes	102.92%	68.53%
ROE	Yes	Yes	68.24%	51.95%
EPS	Yes	Yes	98.55%	66.93%

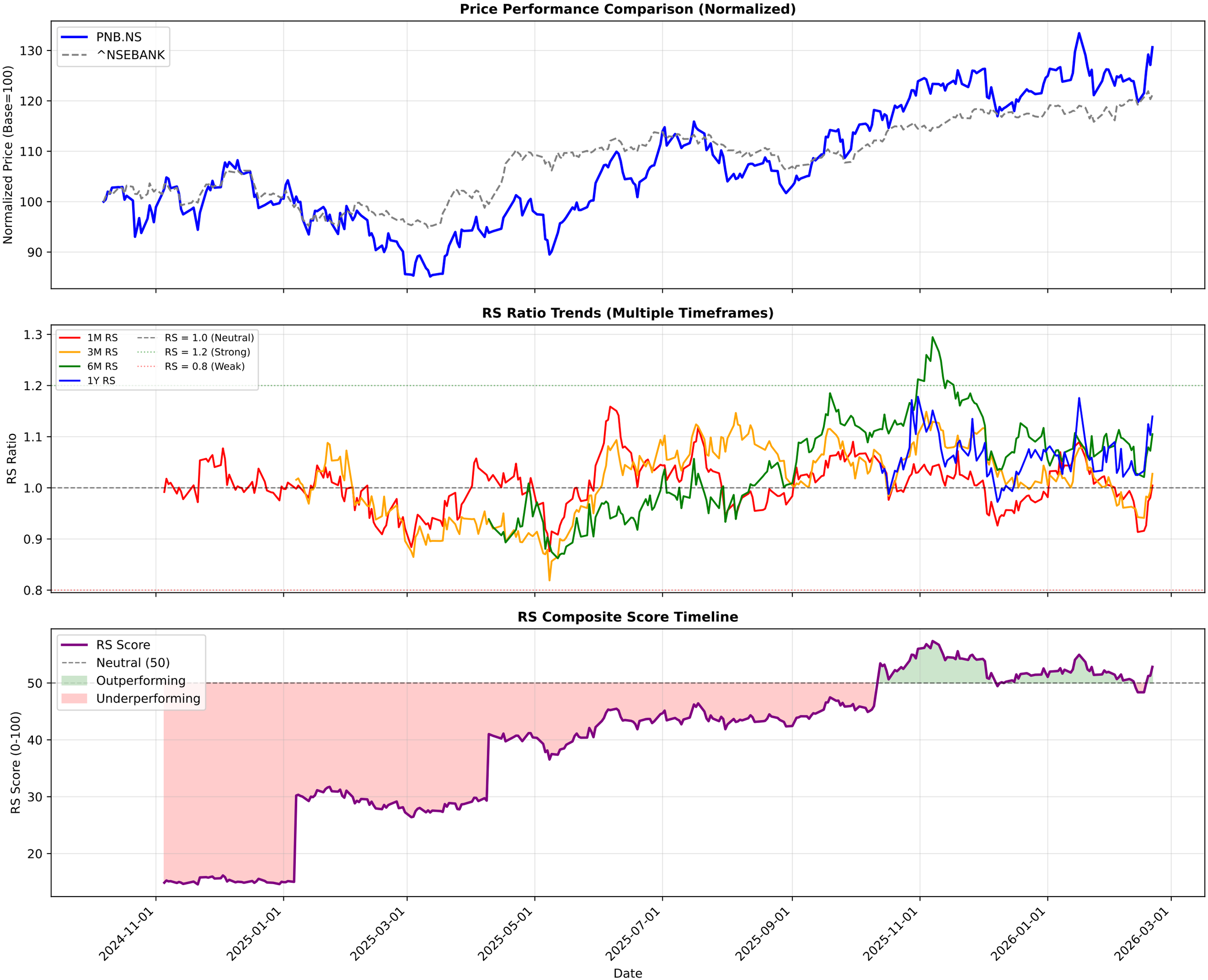
Short-term Fundamental Analysis (6 Quarters)

Metric	Is Growing?	Recent QoQ	Avg QoQ
Revenue	Yes	-2.67%	0.80%
Net Income	Yes	162.09%	27.58%
ROE	Yes	143.08%	21.19%
EPS	Yes	162.50%	59.56%

PNB.NS - Relative Strength Analysis

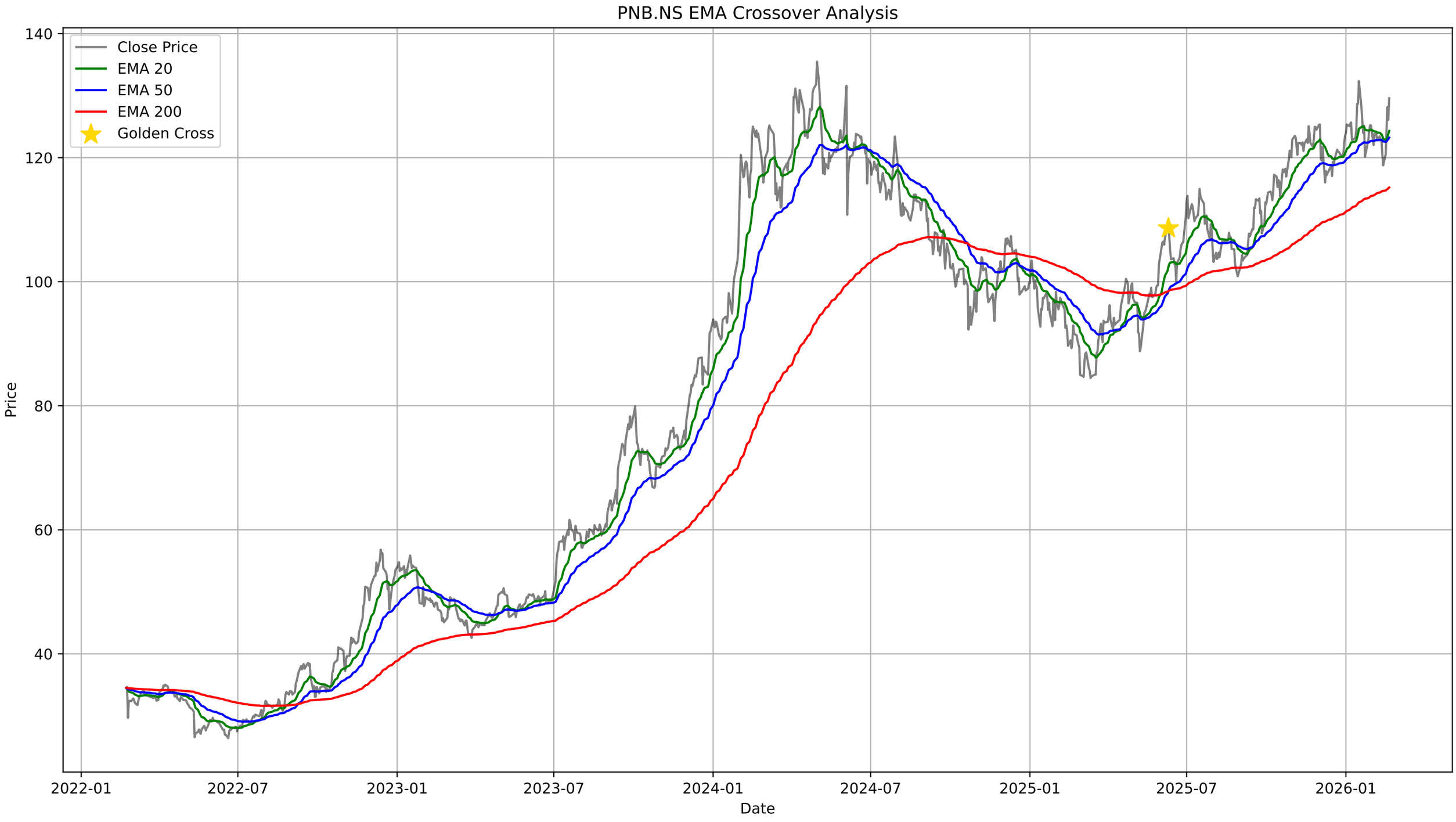
═══ OVERVIEW ═══:	
Benchmark Index:	^NSEBANK
Sector:	Bank
Classification:	**Weakening Leader**
RS Score:	52.8/100
:	
═══ RS RATIOS ═══:	
1M RS:	**1.005 [Leader]**
3M RS:	**1.027 [Leader]**
6M RS:	**1.105 [Leader]**
1Y RS:	**1.140 [Leader]**
:	
═══ TURNAROUND ANALYSIS ═══:	
Turnaround Status:	**Not Detected**
:	
SIGNAL CRITERIA::	
✗ Emerging RS:	**Not accelerating**
✗ Medium-term Lagging:	**Not lagging**
✗ Performance Improving:	**Not improving**

Relative Strength Analysis: PNB.NS vs ^NSEBANK
Classification: Weakening Leader



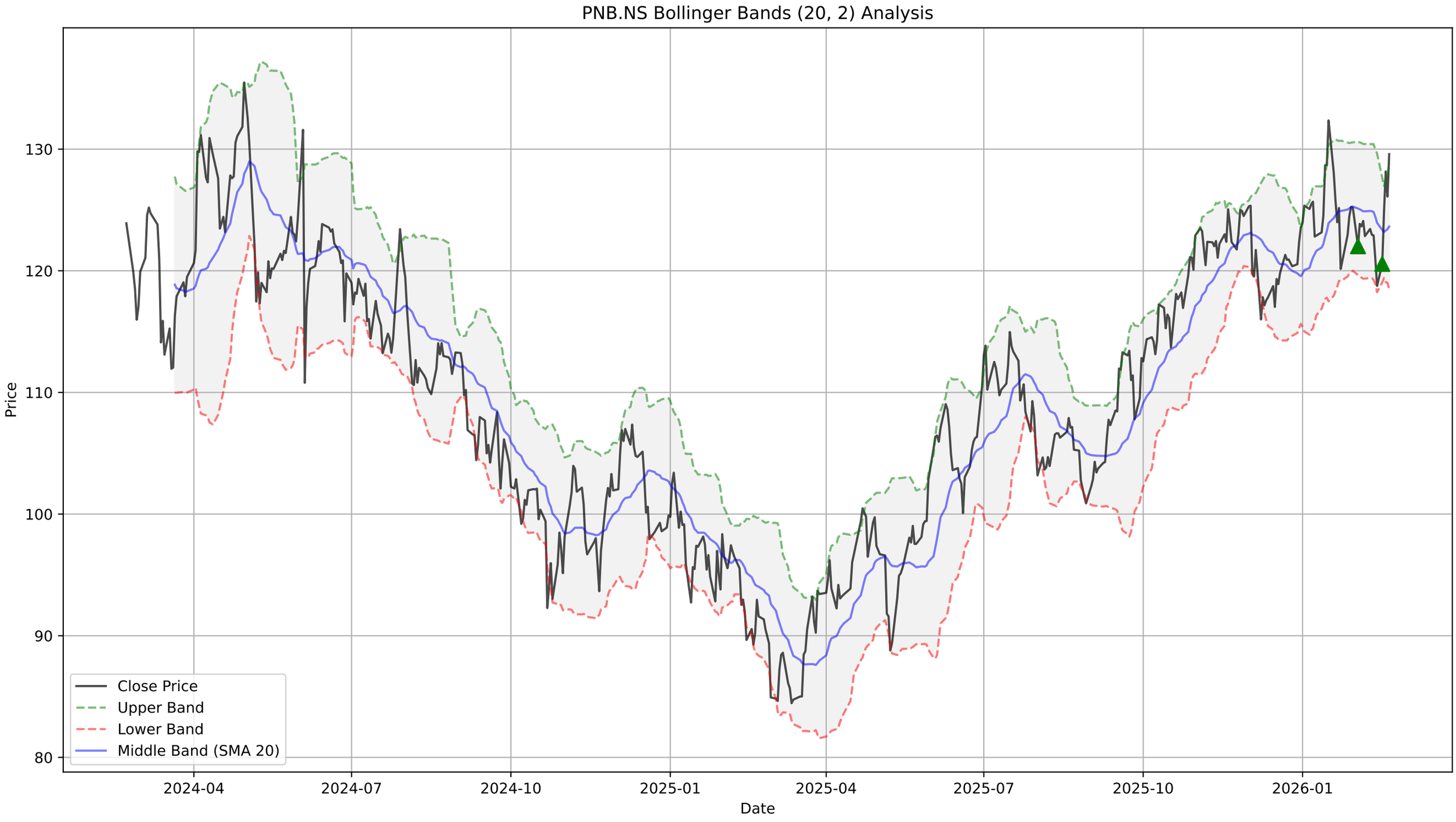
PNB.NS - EMA Crossover Summary

EMA 20:	124.32
EMA 50:	123.24
EMA 200:	115.19
Trend Status:	**Strong Uptrend**
Golden Cross Date:	2025-06-10 00:00:00+05:30
Golden Cross Price:	108.62


PNB.NS EMA Crossover Analysis
Close Price
EMA 20
EMA 50
EMA 200
Golden Cross
Price
Date
140
120
100
80
60
40
2022-01
2022-07
2023-01
2023-07
2024-01
2024-07
2025-01
2025-07
2026-01

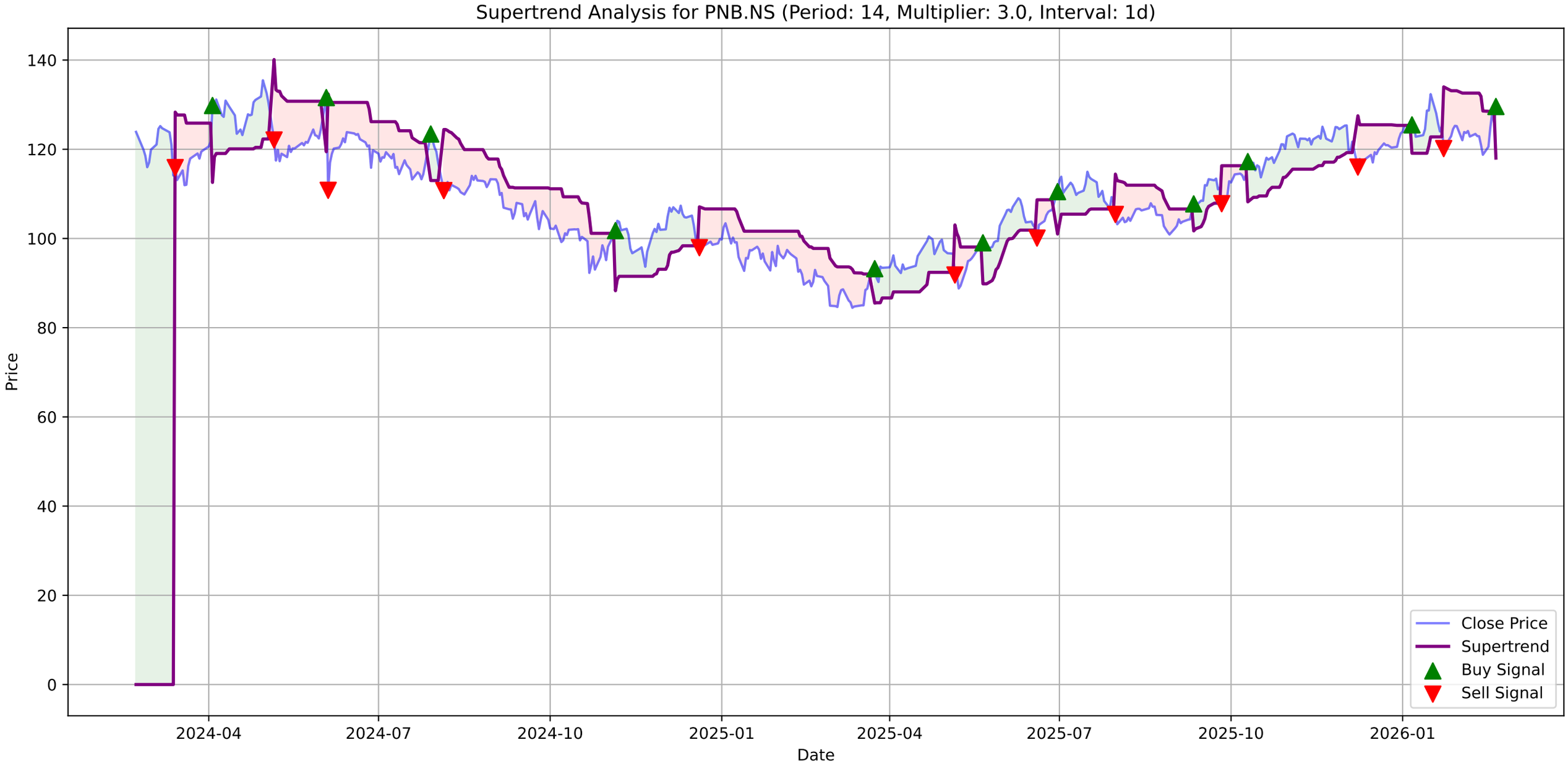
PNB.NS - Bollinger Bands Summary

Current Price:	129.59
Upper Band:	128.81
Middle Band (SMA 20):	123.64
Lower Band:	118.47
%B:	1.0760
Band Width:	0.0836
Status:	Above Upper Band
Signal:	None
Recent Signal 1:	**Buy Signal at 2026-02-02 00:00:00+05:30**
Recent Signal 2:	**Buy Signal at 2026-02-16 00:00:00+05:30**


PNB.NS Bollinger Bands (20, 2) Analysis
Price
Date
130
120
110
100
90
80
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
Close Price
Upper Band
Lower Band
Middle Band (SMA 20)

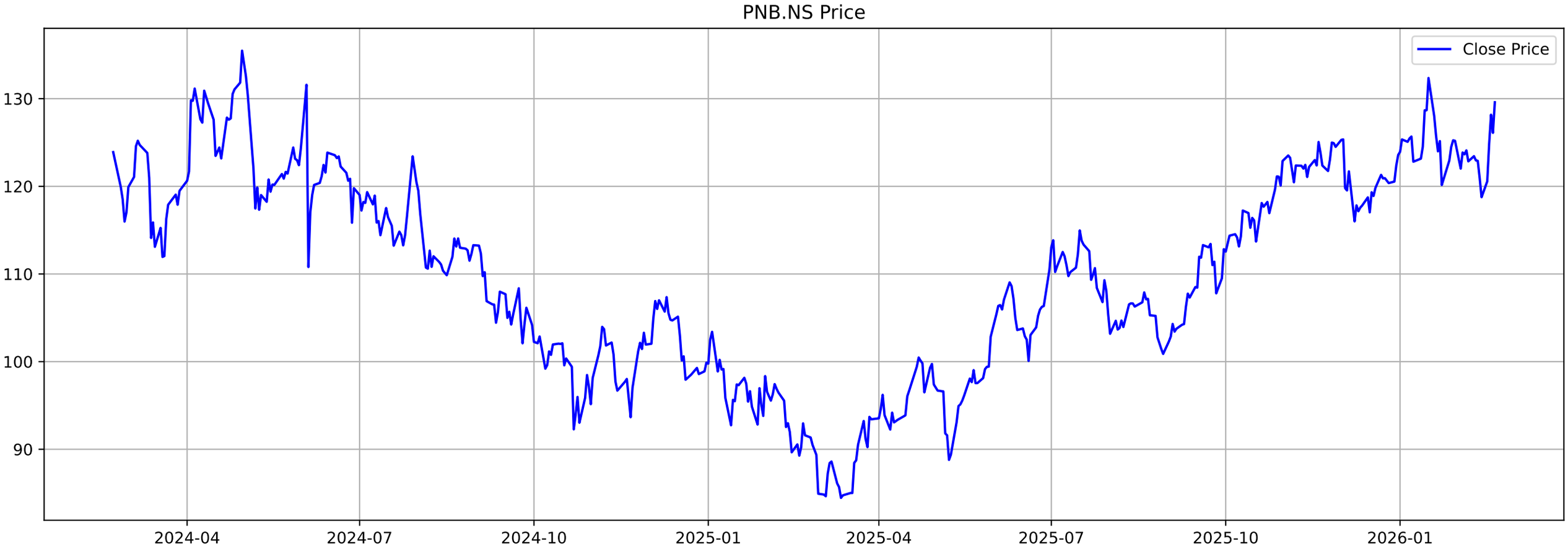
PNB.NS - Supertrend Summary

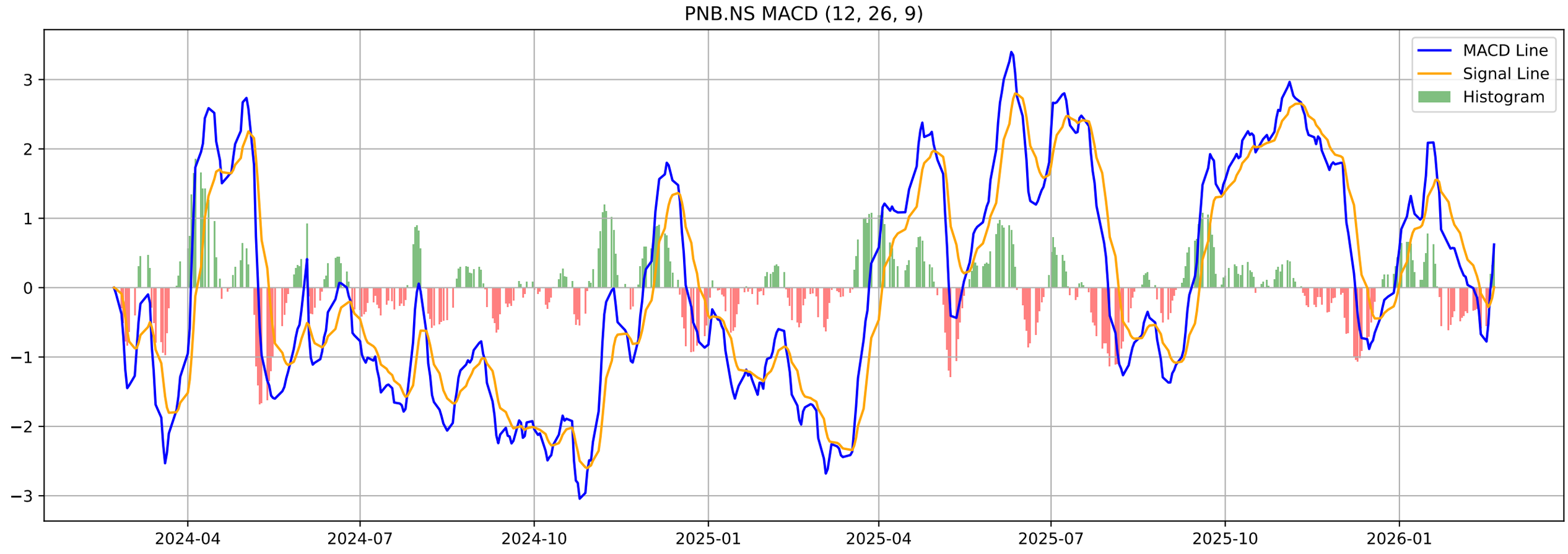
Status:	**UPTREND (Buy)**
Supertrend Value:	118.02
Signal Identified On:	2026-02-20


Supertrend Analysis for PNB.NS (Period: 14, Multiplier: 3.0, Interval: 1d)
Price
Date
140
120
100
80
60
40
20
0
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
Close Price
Supertrend
Buy Signal
Sell Signal

PNB.NS - MACD Summary

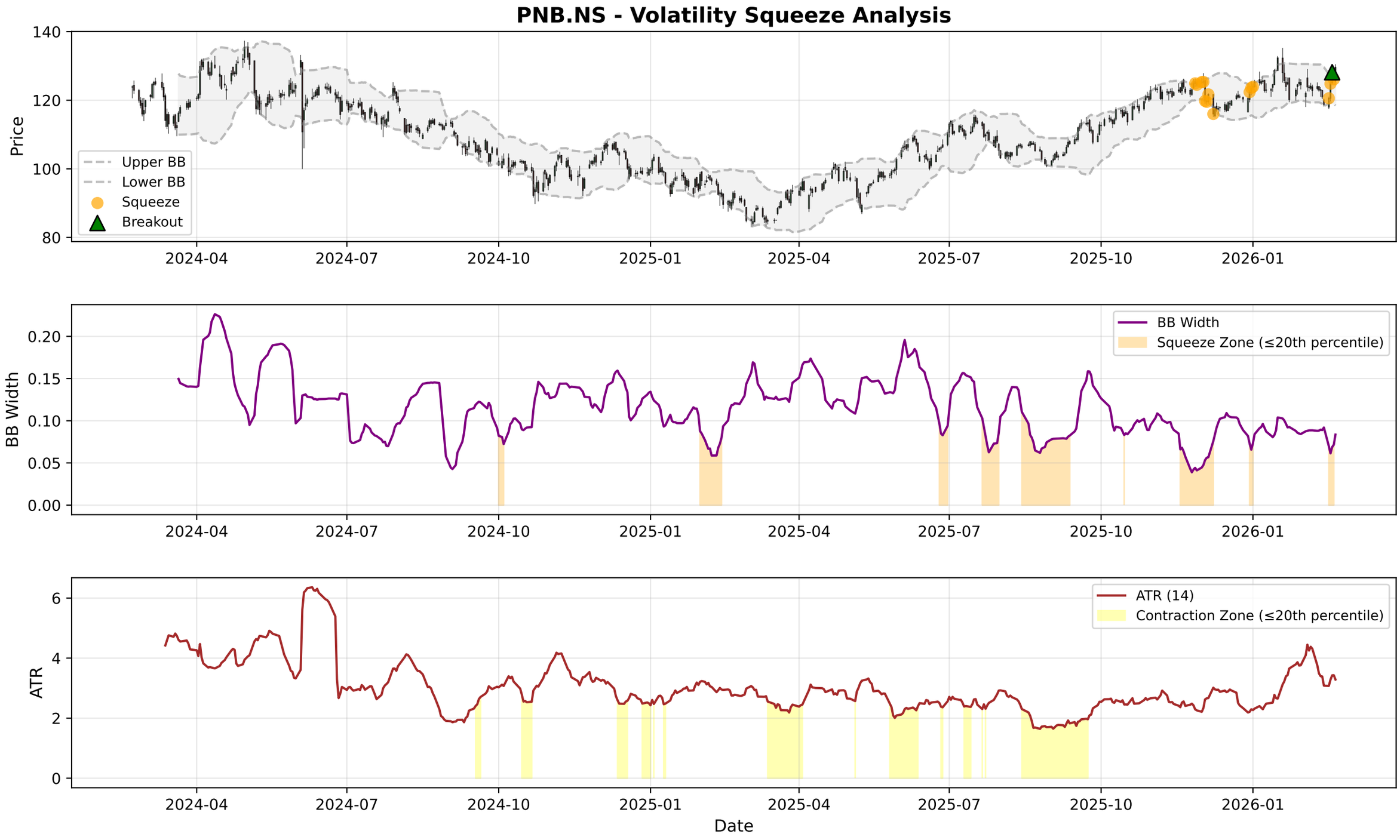
MACD Line:	0.62
Signal Line:	0.01
Histogram:	0.62
Trend:	**Bullish**
Momentum:	**Strengthening**
Signal:	None


PNB.NS Price
Close Price
130
120
110
100
90
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01


PNB.NS MACD (12, 26, 9)
MACD Line
Signal Line
Histogram
3
2
1
0
−1
−2
−3
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01

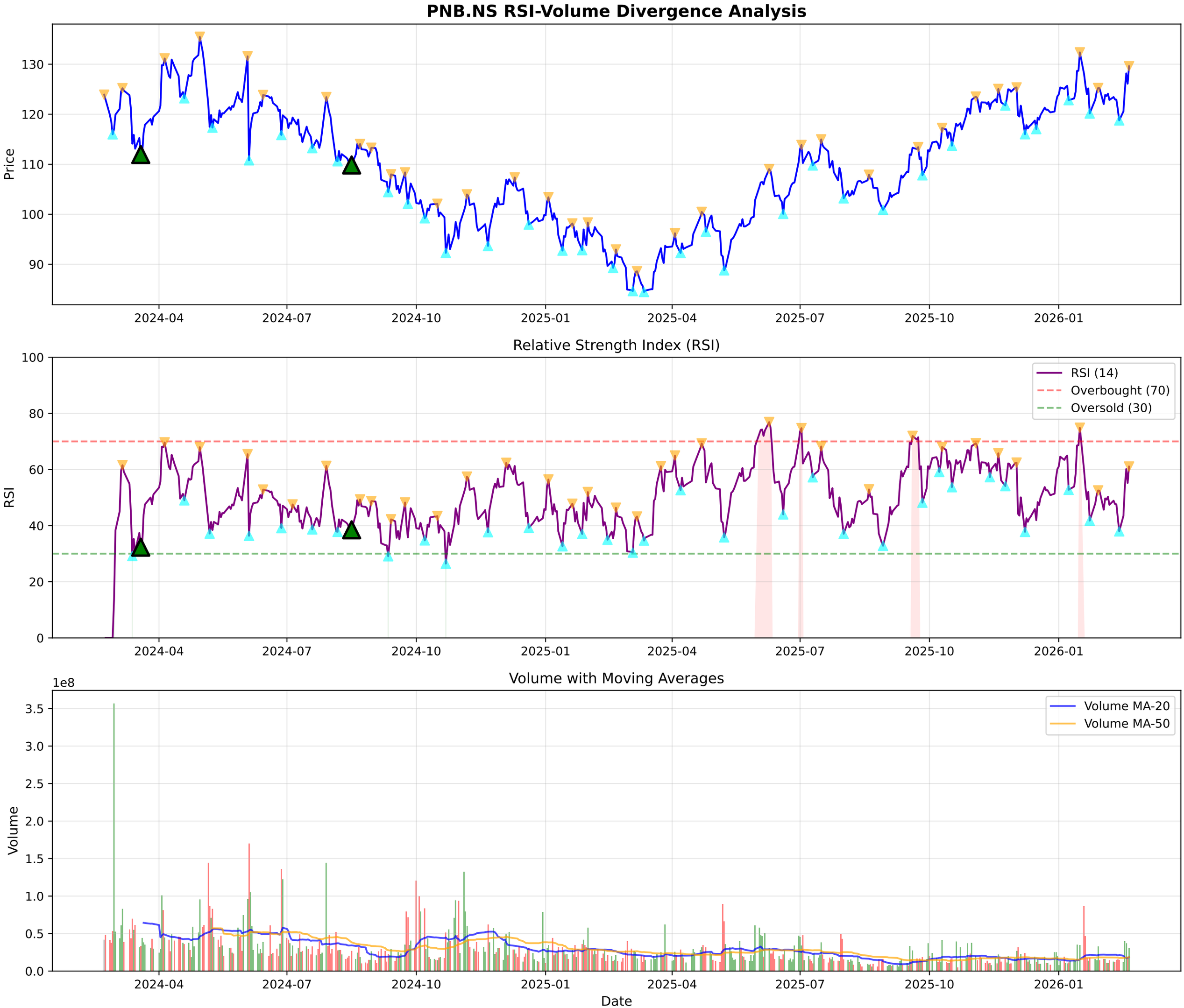
PNB.NS - Volatility Squeeze Summary

BB Width:	0.0836
ATR:	3.2871
Total Signals:	15
Signal 1:	BB Squeeze at 2026-01-01 00:00:00+05:30 (Price: 123.94)
Signal 2:	BB Squeeze at 2026-02-16 00:00:00+05:30 (Price: 120.57)
Signal 3:	BB Squeeze at 2026-02-17 00:00:00+05:30 (Price: 124.82)
Signal 4:	**BB Squeeze (Bullish Breakout) at 2026-02-18 00:00:00+05**
Signal 5:	BB Squeeze at 2026-02-19 00:00:00+05:30 (Price: 126.10)


PNB.NS - Volatility Squeeze Analysis
Price
Upper BB
Lower BB
Squeeze
Breakout
BB Width
BB Width
Squeeze Zone (≤20th percentile)
ATR
ATR (14)
Contraction Zone (≤20th percentile)
Date
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01

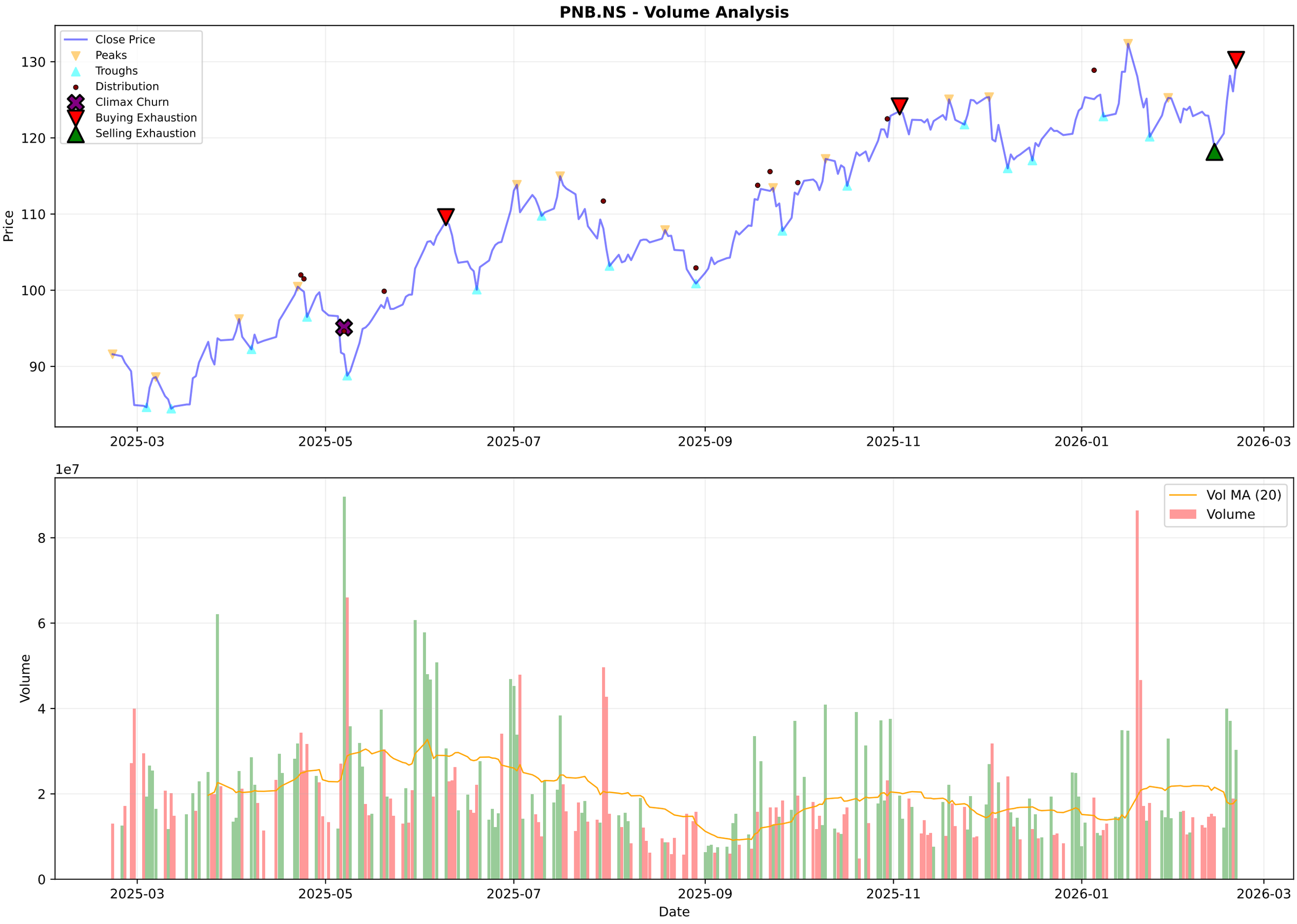
PNB.NS - RSI-Volume Summary

Current RSI:	61.04
Current Volume:	30257099
Volume MA 20:	18534576
Bullish Divergences:	2
Bearish Divergences:	0
Bullish Div 1:	Date: 2024-03-19 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 111.95
Bullish Div 2:	Date: 2024-08-16 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 109.86


PNB.NS RSI-Volume Divergence Analysis
Price
130
120
110
100
90
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
Relative Strength Index (RSI)
RSI
100
80
60
40
20
0
RSI (14)
Overbought (70)
Oversold (30)
Volume with Moving Averages
1e8
Volume
3.5
3.0
2.5
2.0
1.5
1.0
0.5
0.0
Volume MA-20
Volume MA-50
Date

PNB.NS - Volume Analysis

═══ VOLUME ANALYSIS ═══:	
Status:	**16 Signals Detected**
:	
2025-10-30 [-]:	Distribution Day
2025-11-03 [+]:	**Buying Exhaustion (Bearish Div)**
2026-01-05 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-02-13 [+]:	**Selling Exhaustion (Bullish Div)**
2026-02-20 [+]:	**Buying Exhaustion (Bearish Div)**


PNB.NS - Volume Analysis
Close Price
Peaks
Troughs
Distribution
Climax Churn
Buying Exhaustion
Selling Exhaustion
Price
130
120
110
100
90
2025-03
2025-05
2025-07
2025-09
2025-11
2026-01
2026-03
1e7
Vol MA (20)
Volume
Volume
8
6
4
2
0
Date

PNB.NS - Candlestick Classification Summary

═══ CANDLESTICK CLASSIFICATION ═══:	
Latest Classification:	**Buyer Control**
Recent Trend Score (10-day avg):	0.30
:	
Distribution:	
No Control:	118
Buyer Control:	54
Seller Control:	48
Seller Strong Control:	5
Buyer Strong Control:	3

PNB.NS - Candlestick Classification
Seller Strong Control
Seller Control
No Control
Buyer Control
Buyer Strong Control
Price
135
130
125
120
115
110
105
100
1e7
Volume
8
6
4
2
0
2025-06-05
2025-07-01
2025-07-25
2025-08-21
2025-09-17
2025-10-14
2025-11-11
2025-12-05
2026-01-01
2026-01-28
Date

Multi-Timeframe Supertrend Analysis

Timeframe	Status	Value	Last Price	Signal Date
1 Week	**UPTREND (Buy)**	113.11	129.59	2025-05-26
1 Day	**UPTREND (Buy)**	118.02	129.59	2026-02-20
15 Min	**UPTREND (Buy)**	128.47	129.45	2026-02-20

Multi-Timeframe MACD Analysis

Timeframe	Trend	Momentum	Signal
1 Week	**Bearish**	Weakening	No Signal
1 Day	**Bullish**	Strengthening	No Signal
15 Min	**Bearish**	Strengthening	No Signal

PNB.NS - 1 Week (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
200
150
100
50
2016-02-22
2017-02-20
2018-02-19
2019-02-18
2024-02-12
2025-02-10
2026-02-09

PNB.NS - 1 Day (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
140
130
120
110
100
90
2024-02-22
2024-05-09
2024-07-22
2024-09-30
2025-09-24
2025-12-05
2026-02-16

PNB.NS - 15 Min (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
135.0
132.5
130.0
127.5
125.0
122.5
120.0
117.5

Trendlyne Snapshot - PNB_main

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Punjab National Bank

NSE: PNB | BSE: 532461

Punjab National Bank Live Share Price Today, Share Analysis and Chart

Strong Performer

In 4 Starfolio Baskets

ABOUT Punjab National Bank (PNB), founded in 1895 in Lahore and now headquartered in New Delhi, operates across four key segments including treasury, wholesale and retail banking. PNB offers a wide range of personal, corporate, international, and capital s... Read More

129.59 3.49 (2.77%)

↑ Near 52W High of ₹135.15

32.6M NSE+BSE Volume

NSE 20 Feb, 2026 3:31 PM (IST)

Watchlist Portfolio Alert My Notes

Overview FORECASTER STOCK REPORT Buy Sell Zone F&O Financials News Reports Technicals Shareholding Deals Corporate Actions Alerts About

Durability score	Valuation Score	Momentum Score	Analyst Price Target
60.0 / 100	57.2 / 100	66.7 / 100	132
High Financial Strength	Affordable Valuation	Technically Moderately Bullish	1Yr Price target upside is 2%

FORECASTER

Strong Performer These stock companies have strong financials and are affordably priced. They also score high in quality and technic... View Similar Embed DVM

25 S W 4 4 O T 1

SWOT Analysis

Check Before You Buy

VIEW FULL CHECKLIST

High rank 16 Positive • 10 Negative

61.5% Pass in checklist

0 45 55 100

PE Valuation Check

Right Now Undervalued 87%

1 Year Forward Undervalued 70.9%

INSIGHT High 5Yr PE Avg of 15.7 may distort upside values.

DVM
Key Metrics
Price Chart
Forecaster
Financials
Technicals
Shareholding
Deals
Documents
Corporate actions
Company Profile

Punjab National Bank Key Metrics

Preset Metrics: Preset Metrics

ROE Ann. %	Broker Average Target	Market Capitalization	Price to Book
14.8	141.5	148,937.1	
Below industry Median	9.19% upside	Below industry Median	Below industry Median

Trendlyne Snapshot - PNB_forecaster

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MARKETS / SECTOR : BANKING AND FINANCE / INDUSTRY : BANKS / PUNJAB NATIONAL BANK

Punjab National Bank

NSE: PNB | BSE: 532461

Strong Performer

In 4 Starfolio Baskets

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129.59 3.49 (2.77%)

↑ Near 52W High of ₹135.15

32.6M NSE+BSE Volume

NSE 20 Feb, 2026 3:31 PM (IST)

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Punjab National Bank - PNB - stock price prediction, stock forecast, target price, analyst ratings from 17 analysts

Punjab National Bank has a share price target of Rs 132, revenue growth forecast of 5.3%, and profit growth estimate of -2.4% for FY26, based on top 17 analyst calls.

Punjab National Bank FORECASTER - Analyst Estimates

FORECASTER DASHBOARD →

SHARE PRICE TARGET FORECAST

12 MONTH ESTIMATE

↑ HIT Punjab National Bank's share price target is above the current price, with an upside of 1.7%

EPS FORECAST

QUARTER ANNUAL

↑ HIT Punjab National Bank's EPS was higher than average estimate 2 times in past 3 years

CONSENSUS RECOMMENDATION

17 ANALYST Recommendations

HOLD

The consensus recommendation from 17 analysts for Punjab National Bank is HOLD